DeLeeuw: "There were multiple versions of each Helicarrier. The pristine versions can be seen lifting off from the Helicarrier bay. The battle-damaged versions show up later in the fight. These versions were designed to show off the damage of every hit and air-to-air collision.

"We tracked the damage on each of the Helicarriers throughout the battle. Each Helicarrier existed as multiple assets—the pristine version, and the versions with augmented damage. We looked at the tactical position of the Helicarriers in the battle and increased the damage appropriately. With each hit, the geometry of the Helicarriers grew. When a Helicarrier crashes, it lands in the Potomac. Water simulations and destruction simulations tear apart the Helicarrier and flood the Helicarrier bay."

Rodney Fuentebella concept art.